

TB Inverted Phaser

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Overview

Adds deep, rotating phase movement and an unusual sense of space to a sound.

What this plug-in solves

A conventional phaser adds its all-pass path to the dry signal. TB Inverted Phaser subtracts it, producing harder, deeper cancellation notches that remain clearly defined on pads, sustained chords, guitars, and sound-design material.

What you can expect

- Deep moving spectral notches
- Comb-like patterns from one to twelve stages
- Regular or deliberately unstable modulation
- Dry/wet and residual-texture control

How it works

TB Inverted Phaser rotates the phase of selected frequency areas and combines that result with the original signal. The interaction produces a moving series of notches and peaks; the inverted design gives those movements a deeper, less familiar sense of rotation than a conventional phaser.

Stages and Spacing define the complexity of the pattern, Centre and Depth choose where it travels, and Rate plus LFO Shape control the motion. Jitter loosens repetition, while Feedback and Mix determine how dominant the phase pattern becomes. Build the motion first, then add irregularity and feedback.

Quick start

- 1 Choose the number of Stages and set Spacing.
- 2 Place Centre near the source's strongest harmonics.
- 3 Set Depth, Rate, and LFO Shape.
- 4 Raise Amount until the notches are clear.
- 5 Add Feedback carefully.

- 6 Use Jitter only if perfect repetition is unwanted, then level-match Output.

Interface and key sections



This is a direct capture of the current plug-in interface. Use the visible labels to locate the areas and controls explained below.

Stages and Spacing

Stages sets notch count; Spacing changes their distribution. Few stages sound broad, while many stages create a denser comb.

Centre and Depth

Centre places the modulation region and Depth sets its travel around that center.

Rate and LFO Shape

Rate controls speed. Sine and Triangle are smooth, Ramp shapes are directional, and Square produces stepped movement.

Jitter

Adds controlled irregularity to otherwise periodic motion. Use small amounts for organic drift and high amounts for broken modulation.

Amount, Feedback, and Mix

Amount controls the subtractive phase contribution, Feedback reinforces the notch pattern, and Mix blends the complete result with the source.

Output and Programs

Output compensates cancellation or resonant gain. Programs cover pads, glassy hollows, metallic rails, square jolts, and ghost cancellation.

Controllable properties

The guide uses the names shown on the plug-in panel. Each explanation describes the audible result, a useful way to approach the control, and an important interaction to listen for.

Control	What it does and when to use it
Amount	Sets how strongly the named effect changes the sound. Raise it until the contribution is obvious, then reduce it slightly and recheck the sound in the complete mix.
Bypass	Turns the complete effect off or on for a direct before-and-after comparison. Compare with bypass at a similar loudness. If the effect creates a tail, let that tail settle before judging the difference.
Centre	Chooses the main tonal area where the phaser movement is heard. Sweep broadly to find the useful tonal area, then make the focus narrower and the change smaller while listening in the full mix.
Depth	Sets how far the movement travels. Set the speed first and then add only enough movement to hear the pattern without pulling attention away from the performance.
Feedback	Returns the processed sound into the effect to create a longer or stronger result. Increase it slowly and watch the output level. If the sound keeps growing after the input stops, reduce this control before adding more processing.
Jitter	Adds irregular motion so the sweep feels less perfectly repeated. Start with a small amount, then increase it until the motion is clear without hiding the timing or identity of the original sound.
LFO Shape	Chooses the motion pattern of the phaser sweep. Set the speed first and then add only enough movement to hear the pattern without pulling attention away from the performance.
Mix	Blends the original sound with the processed sound. Turn the processed sound up temporarily to learn its character, then return to the mix and keep only the amount that supports the source.
Output	Sets the final listening level after processing. Match the final loudness before deciding whether the processing sounds better. Extra level can make almost any setting seem more impressive.

Control	What it does and when to use it
Program	Loads a factory starting point. Adjust the controls afterward to fit the current sound. Use a preset as a direction, not a finished answer. Change one section at a time so it is clear which adjustment improves the source.
Rate	Sets how quickly the movement repeats. Set the speed first and then add only enough movement to hear the pattern without pulling attention away from the performance.
Spacing	Spreads the phase notches closer together or farther apart. Move it gradually and listen for the point where the intended result becomes clear without introducing a new problem elsewhere.
Stages	Sets how many phase notches are used. More stages create a denser, more complex sweep. Move it gradually and listen for the point where the intended result becomes clear without introducing a new problem elsewhere.

Practical uses

Pad movement

- Use 6-12 stages.
- Choose Sine or Triangle.
- Set slow Rate, broad Depth, and moderate Feedback.

Expected result: The pad develops deep, continuous movement without rhythmic stepping.

Mechanical sweep

- Choose Ramp or Square.
- Raise Feedback and Jitter.
- Use fewer stages for larger, sharper notches.

Expected result: The source gains directional, machine-like spectral motion.

Common pitfalls

Subtractive phase processing can remove substantial energy at particular notes. Reduce the main amount, feedback, drive, or input first, then rebuild the sound while watching the output meter and listening after the source stops.

High Feedback may ring. Reduce the main amount, feedback, drive, or input first, then rebuild the sound while watching the output meter and listening after the source stops.

Always check the effect in mono when it is part of a wider stereo chain. Reduce width or movement and check the result in mono as well as stereo. Preserve the original spatial cues when they are important to the recording.